

Overwatch's New Omnic Hero Shion Has a Human Face--and Fans Have Questions

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Overwatch's next season drops next week, and with it comes Shion, a new **Omnic** damage hero who leads the Hashimoto **clan**. She's a stylish **gunslinger** who can ride and launch a motorcycle at foes, and her distorted, intimidating voice sets her apart from more stoic **Omnics** like Zenyatta. But the moment her design was revealed, a familiar criticism resurfaced: her face looks strikingly humanand strikingly similar to other female heroes. Unlike the overtly robotic, somewhat featureless faces of Zenyatta or Ramattra, Shion has a human-like **visage** with the signature **Omnic** dots relegated to her forehead. This immediately drew comparisons to Anran, a hero released earlier this year who was blasted for resembling Kiriko and Juno. Fans have long speculated that Blizzard gives multiple female characters conventionally attractive, similar faces to boost sales of cosmetic skinsa theory that's hard to shake when you see side-by-side images. However, the outcry isn't unanimous this time. Some players note that Shion actually has a distinct nose, unlike the 'button nose' shared by Juno and Kiriko. 'Shion actually has a different nose for once omg,' tweeted one relieved fan. It's a small victory, but it highlights how closely the community scrutinizes each new face. Beyond the aesthetics, Shion's design raises compelling **lore** questions. In Overwatch's world, tensions between humans and **Omnics** have been a central theme, most prominently in the now-canceled campaign storyline. Why would an **Omnic** leader, who clearly doesn't shy away from attention, choose to look human? Does she harbor a self-hating complex, or is she trying to bridge a divide? If Blizzard leans into that narrative, it could transform a controversial design into a fascinating character study. The studio has been praised for its recent storytelling, so there's hope that Shion's appearance is more than skin-deep. Still, it's hard not to wonder if a bolder, less conventionally attractive design was left on the cutting room floor in favor of **marketability**. As one fan put it, 'a braver, less skin-sale-friendly design was lost in the process.' With Shion set to be a major player in season 3, we may soon get answers. Until then, she's already sparked a conversation about representation, design philosophy, and what we really want from our robot heroes.

Word Treasure

Omnic -- In Overwatch, a sentient robot race that can think and feel like humans, first built as workers and soldiers.

clan -- A powerful family-like group, in this case the Hashimoto clan that operates within Overwatch's world.

gunslinger -- A fighter known for quick-draw shooting, often seen in western movies and cowboy stories.

visage -- A formal word for a person's face or facial appearance.

lore -- The background story, history, and myths of a fictional universe--like all the secrets you discover by playing and reading about a game world.

marketability -- How easy something is to sell; a character your friends want to buy a skin for has high marketability.

Background you need

Overwatch is a team-based shooter game released in 2016 by Blizzard Entertainment (a game developer famous for World of Warcraft and Diablo). In its story, robots called Omnics were created to help humanity, but later many turned hostile in a war called the Omnic Crisis. Some Omnics, like the monk Zenyatta, seek peace; others, like Ramattra, are militant.

A recurring complaint from the community is that many of Overwatch's female heroes--such as Kiriko, Juno, and Anran--share very similar facial features, especially a small 'button nose' and soft features. Fans have made side-by-side image comparisons that spread widely online, fueling debates about whether Blizzard prioritizes selling cosmetic skins over diverse art.

The Omnic storyline was a major part of a planned single-player campaign that Blizzard later canceled, leaving many questions about human-robot tensions unanswered. Shion's release in season 3 could be an attempt to reignite that narrative, or simply a way to introduce a flashy new character with a motorcycle-riding ability.

Break it down

LEAD: Shion, a new Omnic damage hero who rides a motorcycle and leads the Hashimoto clan, arrives with a distorted, intimidating voice.

CONTROVERSY: Her face looks strikingly human, echoing a pattern where female heroes get similar, conventionally attractive faces--fans immediately compared her to Kiriko and Juno.

NUANCE: The criticism isn't unanimous; some players note Shion has a distinct nose, a small victory that highlights how closely the community watches each design.

LORE QUESTION: Why would an Omnic leader choose to look human? Could it hide a self-hating complex or be a move to bridge the human-Omic divide?

UNRESOLVED TENSION: Hope that Blizzard's recent storytelling gives this look a narrative reason vs. suspicion that a bolder, less marketable design was sacrificed.

OPEN QUESTION: Will season 3 deliver a meaningful character study, or is Shion just the latest in a line of skin-sale-friendly heroes?

Why it matters

Video games aren't just about winning matches--they're stories and characters you connect with. When a game keeps recycling the same faces, it can make you feel like your identity isn't represented, and it raises questions about whether artistry or profit is driving the choices. As you grow into tomorrow's game designers or critics, your voice can push for bolder, more diverse creations.

Test what you remember

1. Shion is a new hero of which gameplay role in Overwatch?
 - (A) Tank
 - (B) Support
 - (C) Damage
 - (D) Healer
2. Which group does Shion lead according to the article?
 - (A) The Talon organization
 - (B) The Hashimoto clan
 - (C) The Omnic Liberation Front
 - (D) The Junker gang
3. What immediately made Shion's design controversial?
 - (A) Her motorcycle was too large
 - (B) Her face looked strikingly human, similar to other female heroes
 - (C) Her voice was too quiet
 - (D) Her outfit wasn't colorful enough
4. What small design detail did some fans notice that was different from other female heroes?
 - (A) Her eye color
 - (B) Her nose shape
 - (C) Her hair length
 - (D) Her glove design
5. What narrative hope do players have for Shion's human-like appearance?
 - (A) That she is a spy for Talon
 - (B) That it's tied to a story about the Omnic-human divide
 - (C) That she was born human
 - (D) That it's just a hologram
6. What suspicion about Blizzard's design choices is mentioned repeatedly?
 - (A) They always use the same voice actors
 - (B) They give multiple female heroes similar, conventionally attractive faces to sell skins
 - (C) They only release male heroes
 - (D) They never explain character backstories

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: B 3: B 4: B 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

- 1. Player relief and hope:** Fans who noticed Shion's slightly different nose see it as progress, however tiny. They hope Blizzard is paying more attention and that this Omnic's human-like face will tie into a deep, well-written story about identity and acceptance.
- 2. Critical community voice:** Many long-time players feel Blizzard keeps prioritizing conventionally pretty faces to sell cosmetic skins, especially after Anran's similar controversy. They argue this makes the game's world less imaginative and alienates players who want to see themselves reflected in robot and human designs alike.
- 3. Analytical look at design trends:** Across the gaming industry, female characters often face a 'same-face' problem, where a narrow idea of attractiveness overrides unique art. Overwatch's struggle mirrors a wider challenge for studios: balancing creative vision with the business reality that attractive characters sell more skins.
- 4. Forward-looking potential:** Shion's narrative arc could redefine what it means to be an Omnic, tackling themes of assimilation and self-hatred. If Blizzard commits to that story, it might silence critics and set a new standard for how hero-based games handle identity. Future hero designs might then be judged not just on looks, but on the depth they bring to the world.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):